

3.2.2 Textual studies

Students entering for textual studies themes must also study [Christianity](#) (page 11) or [Catholic Christianity](#) (page 12) in Component 1. There is a separate entry code for this route (see [Entries and codes](#) (page 33)). Students electing for this route must study both textual studies themes (Themes G and H).

In studying these themes, students should be aware of the significance, importance and influence of St Mark's Gospel for individuals, communities and societies. They should understand how varied interpretations of the meaning of passages from St Mark's Gospel may give rise to diversity within Christian traditions and consider how far Christian and non-religious communities give authority to St Mark's Gospel, especially in relation to other sources of contemporary authority. Students should be able to show knowledge of the set texts for study and an understanding of their importance for Jesus, for his early followers and for people of the 21st century. Students should be able to consider the authority of the Gospel and the relevance of Jesus' example and teaching.

3.2.2.1 Theme G: St Mark's gospel: the life of Jesus

The early ministry of Jesus

- John's preparation for Jesus' ministry: 1:1–8.
- Jesus' baptism and temptation: 1:9–13.
- The paralysed man: 2:1–12.
- Jairus' daughter: 5:21–24a, 35–43.
- The rejection at Nazareth: 6:1–6.
- The feeding of the five thousand: 6:30–44.

The later ministry of Jesus

- The conversation at Caesarea Philippi: 8:27–33.
- The transfiguration of Jesus: 9:2–9.
- Jesus' passion prediction: 10:32–34.
- The request of James and John: 10:35–45.
- Bartimaeus: 10:46–52.
- The entry into Jerusalem: 11:1–11.

The final days in Jerusalem

- The Last Supper: 14:12–26.
- Jesus in Gethsemane: 14:32–52.
- The trial before the Jewish authorities: 14:53, 57–65.
- The trial before Pilate: 15:1–15.
- The crucifixion and burial: 15:21–47.
- The empty tomb: 16:1–8.

Significance

- The titles Son of Man, Son of God, Christ (Messiah) and Son of David, including their meaning for 1st century Jews and Jesus.
- The significance for 21st century Christians of Jesus' understanding of the titles Son of Man, Son of God, Christ (Messiah) and Son of David.
- St Mark's portrayal of Jesus as a teacher and miracle worker, including contrasting views on the historicity of the miracle stories.
- Differing beliefs about the meaning of Jesus' words and actions at the Last Supper.
- Differing beliefs about the significance of Jesus' death and resurrection, and different explanations given for the empty tomb.
- Differing views on the authority of St Mark's Gospel relating to the life of Jesus in relation to the challenges posed by secular sources of contemporary authority.

3.2.2.2 Theme H: St Mark's Gospel as a source of religious, moral and spiritual truths

The Kingdom of God

- Parable of the sower: 4:1–9, 14–20.
- Parable of the growing seed: 4:26–29.
- Parable of the mustard seed: 4:30–32.
- Jesus and the children: 10:13–16.
- The rich man: 10:17–27.
- The greatest commandment: 12:28–34.

Jesus' relationships with those disregarded by society

- The man with leprosy: 1:40–45.
- The call of Levi: 2:13–17.
- The Greek (Syro-Phoenician) woman's daughter: 7:24–30.
- The epileptic (demon-possessed) boy: 9:14–29.
- The widow at the treasury: 12:41–44.
- The anointing at Bethany: 14:1–9.

Faith and discipleship

- The call of the first disciples: 1:16–20.
- The woman with a haemorrhage: 5:24b–34.
- The mission of the Twelve: 6:7–13.
- The cost and rewards of discipleship: 8:34–38; 10:28–31.
- Peter's denials: 14:27–31, 66–72.
- The commission and ascension: 16:14–20.

Significance

- The significance and importance for Jesus, for the people of his day and for people in the 21st century, of key events in the life of Jesus recorded St Mark.
- Different ways in which the Kingdom of God might be understood, including as a present reality and a future hope, and as a personal inner state and a community.
- Reasons for 1st century attitudes and those of Jesus to those disregarded by society.
- The significance and importance for Christians of Jesus' attitudes to those disregarded by the society of his day.

- Different views on the significance and importance for Jesus' disciples and for 21st century Christians of discipleship as seen in incidents relating to Jesus' disciples and in Jesus' teaching.
- Different views on the nature and importance of faith as seen in St Mark's Gospel.
- Differing views on the authority of Jesus' teaching as recorded by St Mark in relation to the challenges posed by secular sources of contemporary authority.